

Figure 4.1 Poster for candidate Muhammad Yaqoob Sheikh representing Milli Muslim League in the NA-120 elections, 2017.

removed by the judiciary on charges of corruption. Instead of dismantling such anti-Indian militants, which had been proposed by Sharif before his removal, the military sought to normalize their presence through the political process. The fact that the MML stood for the NA-120 seat that has traditionally belonged to the PML(N), and managed to gain 6,000 votes in a by-election, winning more votes than the PPP, showed the possibility of such parties being successfully mainstreamed in Pakistani politics. It further reinforces the military's support for the 'good' militants, even though such militants have gone astray in the past. Another problematic group that has emerged in Punjab is the Tehreek-e-Labbaik Ya Rasool Allah (TLYR or TLP) as discussed in the introduction to this book.

Cities have been a particular target for terrorist attacks, including the capital Islamabad, especially in 2007 with the siege of the Lal Masjid (Red Mosque).